Tyler Rongxuan Chen

Curriculum Vitae

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Education

Degrees

Ph.D. Political Science and Scientific Computing: University of Michigan, 2023 – 2027 (Expected).

M.A. Statistics: University of Michigan, 2025 – 2027 (Expected).

M.A. Political Science: University of Michigan, 2023 – 2024.

M.A. International and Regional Studies (Southeast Asia): University of Michigan, 2021 – 2023.

B.A. Malay Studies, B.A. Diplomacy Studies: Beijing Foreign Studies University, 2016 – 2020.

Dissertation

Moving Ground: Three Papers on Elites, Voters, and the Breakdown of Dominant Party Systems.

Affiliates

The Michigan Institute for Computational Discovery and Engineering (MICDE)

International Institute (II): Center for Emerging Democracies (CED), Center for Southeast Asian Studies (CSEAS), and Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies (LRCCS)

Institute for Social Research (ISR): Population Studies Center (PSC), Center for Political Studies (CPS), and Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics (CID)

Non-Degree Study Experience

Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), 2022, 2024, 2025.

Indiana University Summer Language Workshop (Japanese), 2024.

Exchange Student, Academy of Malay Studies, University of Malaya, 2018 – 2019.

Research

Book Project

The Tower of Babel We Bury: Geography, Group-Making, and the Communal Foundations of Party Systems.

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles

3. "Myth and Measurement: Spatial Heterogeneity, Ecological Fallacy, and the Urban Narrative in Peninsular Malaysia's Electoral Politics", *Journal of East Asian Studies* 26(1):87–112 [Open Access] [Replication].

2. "Malaysia's Social Transformation and the Fragmentation of Malay Ethnic Parties: A Social Cleavage Structure Perspective" (with Congcong Fu), *Southeast Asian Studies (东南亚研究) [Chinese Social Sciences Citation Index (CSSCI)]* 2021(3):1-29 [Chinese Full Text] [English Translation on SSRN-7118821].

1. "Social Transformation, the Struggle over the Party Line, and the Split of Malaysia's Islamic Party (PAS)" (with Congcong Fu), *Southeast Asian Affairs (南洋问题研究) [CSSCI]* 2020(1):79-95 [Chinese Full Text] [English Translation on SSRN-7118822].

Under Review

3. "The Front Page and the Back Room: Demand Narrowing, Elite Coordination, and the Survival of Authoritarian Elites" [Under Review at *American Political Science Review*].

2. "The Ramification of (Not) Being Governed: Colonial Rule, Social Density, and the Organization of Ethnic Politics in Post-Colonial Malaysia and Indonesia" [Under Review at *International Organization*].

1. "Symbolic Power and the Functional Divide: Campaigns Across the Party-State Spectrum" [Reject & Invitation for Resubmission at *American Journal of Sociology*].

Working Papers

6. "Research Note: Who Counts in 2030? Changes of Representation Under the Proposed Census Exclusions".

5. "What Race and Ethnicity Hide: Bayesian Approximate Computation with Hierarchical Framework (BACH) for Subgroup Voting Behavior under Partisan Polarization, Cross-Cutting Cleavages, and Survey Nonresponse" [SSRN-6610738].

4. "Research Note: A Higher-Order Method of Moments Approach to Ecological Inference under Extreme Survey Nonresponse" [SSRN-6610778].

3. "What the Slope Loses, the Intercepts Gain: Measurement Error and Misattributed Effects in Fixed- and Random-Effects Models." (with Robert Franzese) [Under Revision].

2. "Plant Closures and Trump-Related Twitter Discussion: A Spatial-Temporal Description" (with Robert Franzese) [Under Revision].

1. "Dancing with Hands Tied: Elite Defection, Social Constraints, and the Breakdown of Dominant-Party Systems" [SSRN-7123960].

Work in Progress

4. "Why the Campaign Came Back: Bureaucratization and the Return of Mobilizational Governance in China".

3. "Choosing Voters: Population Policy, Categorical Redistricting, and the Building of a Competitive Authoritarian Regime"

2. "When Do Ruling Parties Campaign Against Their Own States? The Party-State Spectrum" (with Mary Gallagher & Zhen Zhang).

1. "Three Clocks of the Aging Electorate: Period, Cohort, and the Misread Stability of the Senior Bloc in Japan and South Korea" (with Wooseok Kim).

Data Sets

2. "Malaysia Election Panel Data 1959 - 2018", *Available at Zenodo*.

1. "Lower Chamber Elections Archive, Malaysia", *Available at the Constituency-Level Elections Archive (CLEA).*

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant (Graduate Level), ICPSR

"Theoretical Modeling for the Social and Behavioral Sciences", David A. Peterson, 2025
"Causal Inference for the Social Sciences I", Ben Hansen, Jake Bowers, 2025

Tutor (Graduate Level), University of Michigan

POLSCI 599 "Applied Statistical Methods for Political and Social Science Research", Tyler Simko, Fall 2026
POLSCI 599 "Statistical Methods in Political Research I", Licheng Liu, Fall 2025

Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan

POLSCI 373 "Data Science for International Studies", Christopher Fariss, Winter 2026
POLSCI 300 "Quantitative Empirical Methods", Rob Franzese, Fall 2025
POLSCI 327 "Election Law", Jowei Chen, Winter 2025
POLSCI 140 "Intro to Comparative Politics", Pauline Jones, Fall 2024
POLSCI 389 "Human Rights", Ragnhild Nordås, Winter 2023
SOC 430 "World Population Dynamics", Barbara Anderson, Fall 2022

Awards, Grants, & Fellowships

University of Michigan

MICDE Fellowship, 2026
Department of Political Science Director of Graduate Studies (DGS) Research Grant, 2026
ISR Next Generation Award – The Tessler Fellows Fund, 2026
Rackham Graduate Student Research Grants, 2022, 2026
Advanced Research Computing Grant, 2026
Political Science Department DGS Conference Travel Grant, 2024, 2026
ISR – Rackham Summer Training Awards, 2024, 2025
Rackham Graduate School Conference Travel Grant, 2024, 2025

College of Literature, Science, and the Arts (LSA) Technology Support Grant, 2024
Center for Japanese Studies Summer Language Fellowship, 2024
Political Science Department Research Grant, 2023, 2024
University Library Research Grant, 2023
CED Fellowship, 2022
II Student Fellowship, 2022
II Travel Funds, 2022
Global Individual Grants, 2022
CSEAS Southeast Asian Language Scholarship (Indonesian), 2021

Beijing Foreign Studies University

Excellent Senior Thesis Award for Both Degrees, 2020
University Scholarships, 2017, 2018, 2019

External

American Political Science Association (APSA) Democracy and Autocracy Section Travel Award, 2026
The Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth) Conference Travel Award, 2025
Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society, 2023
Beijing Outstanding Graduate, 2020

Conferences and Workshops

Conference Presentations

APSA Annual Meeting, 2024, 2025, 2026
PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting, 2025, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Meeting, 2025
American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting, 2024, 2025
Social Science History Association (SSHA) Annual Meeting, 2024

Workshops

The Japanese Politics Online Seminar Series (JPOSS), 2026
CED Book Workshop with Joel Selway, 2024

Service to Department, University, & Profession

Graduate Education and Training in Southeast Asian Studies (GETSEA) Consortium

Graduate Student Council Member, 2023 – 2026

University of Michigan

Co-Organizer, China Reading Group [Website], 2023 –

Graduate Student Representative, Department of Political Science Hiring Committee, 2026
Member, LSA Graduate Student Advisory Council (GSAC), 2025 – 2026
President, Graduate Association of Political Scientists (GAPS), 2025 – 2026
Member, Political Science Honors Thesis Committee, 2025
Mentor, The Eldersveld Emerging Scholars Conference, 2024
Co-Organizer, Interdisciplinary Workshop in Comparative Politics, 2023 – 2024

Journal Referee

Social Forces, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Field Methods*

Industry Experience

NielsenIQ

Business Analyst (Consumer Packaged Goods Section, Beijing Office), 2020 – 2021

Languages and Skills

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Bilingual Proficiency), Malay (Advanced, ∼10 years), Indonesian (Advanced, ∼5 years), Japanese (Intermediate, ∼2.5 years)

Skills

R, Python, Stata, Stan, ArcGIS, NetLogo, C++, LaTeX, High-Performance Computing (SLURM), Bash Scripting, Parallel Job Management

References

Robert Franzese
Professor of Political Science
University of Michigan
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Allen Hicken
Professor of Political Science
University of Michigan
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Mary Gallagher
Professor of Global Affairs
University of Notre Dame
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